



OnePlus 10 Pro debuts in China

The OnePlus 10 Pro with a Samsung Galaxy S21-style camera array debuts in China.
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Apple hits \$3 trillion valuation

Apple becomes the first company in the world to hit a valuation of \$3 trillion.
<https://digit.in/jan22-18>

Apple AirPods 3

A step up over its predecessor

Apple is often credited as the company that ushered in the era of truly wireless earphones, and for good reason. The original Apple AirPods exploded a segment in its infancy to massive levels of popularity. Apple recently launched the third generation of its AirPods lineup – the Apple AirPods 3. Are the 3rd-Gen AirPods worth their price tag of ₹18,500? Let's find out.

BUILD, DESIGN AND COMFORT

The AirPods 3 are all-white, minimalist earphones with protruding curved stems. They come with a new contoured design. The stem is 33 per cent shorter than the AirPods 2's stem, which makes them more inconspicuous. The earphones are also pretty lightweight and the case is pretty pocketable.

As for fit and comfort, this is where the AirPods 3 can be a bit polarising. Unlike the AirPods Pro, you don't get ear tips on these buds and they have a semi-open design like the AirPods Gen2. While this will appeal to those who don't like the earbuds pushing too deep into the ear canals, the fit does feel less secure especially when working out or jogging.

FEATURES

Most TWS earphones in this price range sport Active Noise Cancellation, but you won't find that feature on these buds. But we sorely missed on these buds mainly due to the lacking passive isolation. If you're in a noisy environment, ambient sounds will definitely make their way through.

The lacking Active Noise Cancellation feature aside, the AirPods 3 do come with an array of features. The earphones and the charging case are rated IPX4, so they are resistant to light splashes of water. The case can be wirelessly charged on a Magsafe charger or any Qi-enabled wireless charger.



Next, the buds come equipped with a skin-detect sensor that auto-pauses music when the bud leaves your ear and resumes it when it's back in. You also get force-sensitive capacitive controls that allow you to register music controls by squeezing the stem.

The earphones come with hands-free Siri, exclusive to Apple devices, of course, so you can simply say Hey Siri to make a call, play music, get directions and more.

There are also a bunch of other Apple-exclusive features such as Audio Sharing, Fast Pairing, Apple's Find My network integration, and more. These features set these earphones apart from the competition and if you're using an Android phone, you will miss out on these features, so keep that in mind.

PERFORMANCE

The AirPods 3 has a bright sound profile with recessed bass notes and pronounced mids and highs. The earbuds are semi-open, so due to this design, they do struggle to form a seal that can effectively produce the punch and rumble of low bass.

The rest of the frequency range, however, is well-balanced and detailed. The mids are present and clear so vocals and lead instruments sound quite pristine in the mix and the highs are also well-produced with ample detail.

The sound signature of the AirPods 3 is especially good for podcasts, audiobooks, and even films and TV shows.

Now, moving on to Spatial Audio, the effect produced is pretty impressive. The positioning of the vocals and instruments in the 3-dimensional space make tracks come alive.

BATTERY LIFE

The 3rd Gen AirPods come with improved battery life rated at 6 hours on the buds alone, and a total of 30 hours with the charging case.

With Spatial Audio enabled, the earphones lasted 4 hours and 20 minutes. The case provided about 4 additional charges to the earbuds.

Additionally, the earphones come with quick charge, where a 5-minute charging session will net you an hour's worth of playback.



BUILD	66
FEATURES	72
PERFORMANCE	72
VALUE	70

VERDICT

The Apple AirPods 3 are, no doubt, a big step up in terms of performance, features and build from their predecessors. They offer a wide array of enticing features, especially for Apple users, including Spatial Audio, hands-free Siri, IPX4 rating, Audio Sharing, and more. If you're an Apple user, you will get access to even more quality of life features.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

CHIP: H1 headphone chip | AUDIO TECHNOLOGY: Custom high-excursion Apple driver, Custom high dynamic range amplifier | SPATIAL AUDIO: Yes, with dynamic head tracking | MICROPHONE: Dual beamforming microphones | IP RATING: IPX4 | BATTERY LIFE: 6 hours on earbuds (Spatial Audio off), 30 hours with charging case | FAST CHARGE: Yes, 5 minutes charge provides 1 hour of playback | BLUETOOTH VERSION: Bluetooth 5.0

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